

Melissa Gonzalez Soto, PhD.

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SUMMARY OF SKILLS AND QUALIFICATIONS

- **Scientific communication:** Produce clear, audience-tailored scientific materials, including abstracts, posters, slide decks, and manuscripts; author of 8 peer-reviewed publications.
- **Clinical research:** Support study design (endpoints/outcomes) and trial planning/execution; strengthen funding submissions through grant proposal editing.
- **Ethics and clinical documentation:** Prepare REB submissions and amendments; draft consent and recruitment materials; TCPS2 certified.
- **Data management and interpretation:** Manage data in REDCap and Excel; perform statistical analysis and visualization in JMP (SAS Institute) and GraphPad Prism.
- **Project management and team collaboration:** Coordinate research staff to deliver projects on time; provide regular updates to principal investigators.
- **Languages:** English (advanced), Spanish (native), French (basic).

EDUCATION

PhD in Human Health and Nutritional Sciences

September 2021- December 2025

University of Guelph

Thesis: "Investigating the effects of milk protein vs. soy protein on omega-3 polyunsaturated fatty acid metabolism and energy balance: Evidence from preclinical and clinical models."

MSc in Human Health and Nutritional Sciences

September 2019-August 2021

University of Guelph

Thesis: "Soy consumption, but not dairy consumption, is inversely associated with fatty acid desaturase activity in young adults."

BSc in Nutrition and Food Science

August 2013- July 2017

Universidad Iberoamericana, Mexico City

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Clinical Research Coordinator, University of Guelph, 2023-present

- Collaborate with principal investigators on study design for a multi-site randomized human nutrition trial.
- Contribute to editing grant proposal submissions to support study funding.

- Prepare and submit ethics documentation (REB package, consent, and recruitment materials) and maintain version alignment to support compliant approvals.
- Lead trial execution: participant recruitment and communication, visit scheduling, treatment preparation, biospecimen collection and processing, participant briefing and support, and visit-payment/budget tracking.
- Train and supervise a team of 4 students to ensure protocol adherence and consistent study procedures.
- Produce clear scientific summaries and visuals for investigators; translate complex findings into conference presentations and manuscripts for publication.

President, Science 2 Business Network (S2BN) — 2022 - 2025

- Led a team of 5 volunteers to plan and deliver industry panels and networking events.
- Scoped topics, built timelines and budgets, recruited industry professionals as speakers, moderated panel discussions, and managed end-to-end execution to ensure high-quality events.

Graduate Researcher (Preclinical animal feeding study), University of Guelph, 2020-2021

- Executed an 8-week feeding protocol with detailed feeding/weight logs, tissue collection, and sample processing supporting two peer-reviewed publications.
- Trained and supervised two trainees on randomization, sample collection and processing SOPs to deliver complete, reproducible datasets for downstream analyses.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Guelph— 2020 - 2025

- Delivered Biology and Nutrition laboratories and seminars, fostering an inclusive and respectful environment to encourage critical thinking through guided discussions.
- Reviewed assignments and exams, providing constructive feedback and mentoring students to improve scientific writing skills.

VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCE

The Dog Go Project Mexico — Volunteer Translator and Writer

July 2022 - Present

- Translated veterinary reports from Spanish to English and collaborated with a team of volunteers to write engaging adoption biographies, supporting the adoption of multiple dogs in Canada.